PwC Digital Strategy

Partner-Ready Insight Pack

Technology strategy engagement: proposed healthcare acquisition for new-market entry

Version 2, updated with Actionable Insights v2 and Evidence Map v2 | Client: multinational healthcare company (name not stated) | Draft for partner review | 31 October 2026

Basis. This pack supersedes version 1 (Insight_Pack.docx), which is unchanged. It uses only the eight interview transcripts, the reports built from them, and the follow-up interview (Int-09, client sponsor), as carried into Actionable Insights v2 and Evidence Map v2. No new data has been created. "Evidence" means what stakeholders said, and "interpretation" is the consultant's reading. No statement is independently verified. S1 to S8 are stakeholder IDs, ST-xx are statement register IDs, Int-xx are interview numbers, and FU-xx are follow-up statements.

Orange shading	Marks evidence or status from the follow-up interview (Int-09). Interview 09 is a fictional practice transcript, and its statements describe the client's process status and management's account of the target. They are unverified. Unshaded text is carried over from version 1.

1. Executive summary

- **The interviews define what must be proven; they report no findings about the target.** All transcripts are fictional practice transcripts that say their statements "require validation". **Follow-up (Int-09):** the client sponsor confirms nothing has been independently verified and the data room is not yet open (FU-08, FU-07).
- **The thesis is not yet testable.** The Chief Strategy Officer (S1) says it has not been shown which advantages the target owns, or whether a partnership would work. **Follow-up:** the target is now described only by management's account (FU-01 to FU-03), and no criteria exist for comparing the entry routes (FU-15).
- **Stakeholders ask for verification, not assertion, and set separate decision gates.** Seven stakeholders ask for original or independent evidence, and four (S1, S3, S4, S6) describe pause, escalation or conditional criteria. **Follow-up:** thresholds are not approved, and expected gate owners are not agreed (FU-10 to FU-12).
- **Market size, launch dates and integration pace are things to model, not assume.** No timelines or figures appear in the original transcripts. **Follow-up:** the Market B regulatory pathway is unconfirmed, there is no integration plan, and the decision date is not fixed (FU-05, FU-20, FU-24).
- **Technology evidence is thin and rests mainly on one stakeholder (S5, the CIO / Health Data & Cybersecurity Lead). Follow-up:** data rights are unknown, AI is "an aspiration, not a plan", and the integrate-or-separate decision is open (FU-18, FU-17, FU-19). These interviews do not support an acquisition recommendation.

2. Evidence-backed insight headlines

Insight	Headline	Follow-up status (Int-09)
Insight 1	The acquisition thesis is not yet testable: what the target is, and whether its advantage is exclusive, is unproven.	The target is described only by management (FU-03). No criteria exist to compare the routes (FU-15).
Insight 2	Verification, not management assertion, should be the evidence standard, and the decision gates need to be agreed once with the client.	Nothing is independently verified (FU-08). Thresholds are not approved (FU-10).

Insight	Headline	Follow-up status (Int-09)
Insight 3	Model the access, approval and integration pathway country by country, rather than assuming market size, launch dates or speed.	The Market B pathway is unconfirmed (FU-05). No integration plan exists (FU-20).

Headlines are interpretations supported by stakeholder statements. None is a verified finding about the target. The follow-up did not change any headline.

3. Evidence table

Confidence is a qualitative judgement of how consistent and direct the supporting statements are. It is not a statistic. No insight rates above moderate, because no target-specific or independently verified evidence exists. The follow-up confirms gaps but adds no verified evidence, so no confidence level changed.

Insight	Supporting stakeholder evidence	Limitations	Confidence explanation	Follow-up evidence (Int-09)
1. Thesis not yet testable	S1 states that ownership of advantages and the partnership alternative are untested (ST-01b). S2, S3, S4, S5, S6 each say their evidence needs depend on what the target is (Int-02, 03, 04, 05, 06). S1, S2, S8 raise the risk that advantages or relationships may not transfer (ST-04, ST-10, ST-38).	No data on the target in the original interviews. Only S1 raises partnership and organic entry as alternatives. Transfer statements are conditional ("may", "if"); none says the problem exists.	Moderate that the thesis is untested, because S1 says so directly and several others agree. No confidence can be expressed on whether the advantage exists or is exclusive: there is no evidence either way. v2: no change.	Target described as a mid-sized medical technology company with connected devices and a cloud monitoring platform, in Market A, with Market B under consideration (FU-01, FU-02, FU-26). This is management's account (FU-03), and product-level detail has not been seen (FU-04). No criteria for comparing routes (FU-15). Customer contact not permitted (FU-22).
2. Verification and shared gates	S1, S2, S3, S4, S5, S6, S8 each ask for original, independent or customer-sourced evidence (ST-08, 11, 14, 17, 23, 28, 41; Int-01). S1, S3, S4, S6 state pause, escalation or conditional-recommendation criteria (ST-04, 15, 20, 31).	No one reports what management has claimed, or that any claim is false. Gate framing differs by role (pause, escalate, conditional). Client investment thresholds are not stated.	Moderate that a verification standard is shared across functions. Low to moderate on gates: thresholds are unstated and framing differs, so whether stakeholders align on them is not established. v2: no change.	Nothing independently verified (FU-08); data room not open (FU-07); management has provided a presentation, summary financials and a high-level regulatory overview (FU-06). Thresholds not approved (FU-10). Expected gate owners (CMO, Regulatory Director, CFO) are not agreed (FU-11, FU-12). Effect of escalation undecided (FU-13).
3. Pathway, not assumptions	S1, S2, S7, S8 say market size does not show access or capacity (ST-02, 07, 32, 37). S4, S8 say approvals and local steps should be modelled (ST-16, 19, 39). S3, S5, S7 warn integration can disrupt continuity (ST-24, ST-35; ST-13).	No timelines, forecasts or capacity data in the original interviews. The link between "speed" and the delay points is a consultant inference and is unvalidated. All statements are general; scope of countries and products is unknown.	Moderate that stakeholders consider these factors must be modelled. Unvalidated that speed conflicts with them, because no interviewee draws that link. v2: no change.	Market B regulatory pathway not confirmed (FU-05). Decision date planned but not fixed (FU-24). No integration plan (FU-20); stop authority not defined (FU-21); integrate-or-separate undecided (FU-19). Preference for acquisition rests on a belief that it is faster, with no timeline per option (FU-16). This supports "speed is untested", not "speed conflicts with constraints".

4. Stakeholder agreement and disagreement

Type	Topic	Stakeholders	Note
Agreement	Independent evidence over management claims	S1, S2, S3, S4, S5, S6, S8	Stated consistently in different words. No one disputes it.
Agreement	Market size does not show accessibility or capacity	S1, S2, S7, S8	Raised from strategy, commercial, operations and country angles.
Agreement	Regulatory and local steps are country-specific and affect timing	S1, S2, S4, S8	General statements; no target data.
Agreement	Integration can threaten continuity and safe operation	S3, S5, S7	General risk statements; no incident cited.
Agreement	Evidence needs depend on what the target is	S2, S3, S4, S5, S6, S7	A point about method; says nothing about the target.
Difference (stated)	Decision gates are framed differently: S6 allows a "conditional" recommendation; S1, S3, S4 describe pausing or escalating	S1, S3, S4, S6	May reflect roles, not disagreement. Not validated as a conflict.
Difference (coverage)	Only S1 raises partnership and organic entry; only S5 develops data and cyber in depth	S1; S5	A gap in coverage, not a disagreement. Other stakeholders do not oppose either point.

Type	Topic	Stakeholders	Note
Possible tension (inference)	S1's "speed" versus approval, procurement and integration constraints from S2, S4, S7, S8	S1 vs S2, S4, S7, S8	Consultant inference, unvalidated. S1's speed refers to entry and S7's caution to integration pace.
Direct contradictions	None found between any pair of the original interviews	All	Reflects these eight transcripts only.
Follow-up observation (Int-09)	No follow-up statement contradicts the original interviews. They confirm that several things the stakeholders ask for are not yet in place.	Client sponsor vs S1 to S8	Consultant observation from comparing FU-01 to FU-26 with the original statements.
Follow-up observation (Int-09)	Gate ownership: expected owners are the CMO, Regulatory Director and CFO, but this is an expectation and not agreed (FU-11, FU-12). No named owner for S1's pause criteria.	S1, S3, S4, S6; client sponsor	The S6 versus S1/S3/S4 framing difference is not resolved by the follow-up.
Follow-up observation (Int-09)	The sponsor describes the acquisition preference as a belief about speed that has not been tested (FU-16). This is consistent with S1's "not yet shown" (ST-01b).	S1; client sponsor	The conflict with approval and integration constraints remains unvalidated.

5. Practical recommendations

These recommendations concern how to build the evidence base. They are consultant interpretation. They are not a recommendation to proceed with, or to stop, the acquisition.

ID	Recommendation	Basis	Follow-up status (Int-09)
R1	Fix the target facts first: obtain the target's business description, product and service list, countries, revenue model and technology estate.	Insight 1. S2, S3, S4, S5, S6 say their evidence needs depend on the target.	A management description has been given (FU-01 to FU-04, FU-26). It is unverified, and whether the platform is sold separately is unknown (FU-04).
R2	Test the advantage and the alternatives: check exclusivity and transfer using contracts, change-of-control terms and customer references, and compare acquisition with partnership and organic entry.	Insight 1. S1 asks for an assessment of alternatives (ST-05).	Customer contact is not permitted (FU-22). No comparison criteria exist (FU-15).
R3	Build an evidence register separating verified facts, management claims and untested assumptions, and issue a data request for original records.	Insight 2. S1 asks for this separation (Int-01); S4 and S6 ask for reconciliation to originals.	Nothing is verified (FU-08) and the data room is not open (FU-07).
R4	Agree one decision-gate framework and obtain the client's investment thresholds before diligence findings arrive.	Insight 2. S1, S3, S4, S6 each state different triggers; S6 says thresholds must come from the client.	Thresholds not approved (FU-10). Gate owners not agreed (FU-12). Effect of escalation undecided (FU-13).
R5	Model the pathway: map licences and approvals by country, build a comparative timeline for the three entry routes, and put approval timing into the forecast.	Insight 3. S4 asks for the pathway to be modelled (ST-19).	Market B pathway not confirmed (FU-05). No timeline per option (FU-16).
R6	Scope a technology diligence workstream on S5's requests: system and data-flow inventory, separation of safety-critical from administrative systems, cyber and incident evidence, and a validation and continuity plan before any system change. Treat any AI opportunity as a hypothesis.	Insights 2 and 3. S5 (ST-21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26). Interpretation: this rests on one stakeholder.	Data rights, storage and cross-border flow unknown (FU-18). Integrate-or-separate undecided (FU-19). AI is "an aspiration, not a plan" (FU-17).
R7	Define Day 1 safeguards early: what must stay stable, who can stop a change, and the continuity plan.	Insight 3. S3 and S7 (ST-13, ST-35, ST-36).	No integration plan (FU-20). Stop authority not defined (FU-21).

6. Validation actions and data required

Data requested is limited to what stakeholders asked for. None of it was supplied.

ID	Area	Data required	Requested by	Supports	Follow-up status (Int-09)
V1	Target profile	Business description; products and services; countries; revenue model including whether payers or reimbursement are involved	S2, S4, S6	R1	Management description given (FU-01, FU-02, FU-26). Whether the platform is sold separately is unknown (FU-04). Verification awaits the data room (FU-07).
V2	Advantage and relationships	Customer contracts with change-of-control terms; contract durations and renewal dates; distributor agreements; customer references; map of key individuals	S1, S2, S8	R2	Customer contact not permitted (FU-22). No comparison criteria (FU-15). No follow-up evidence on exclusivity.
V3	Regulatory	Licence and registration register by country; inspection reports; regulator correspondence; pending applications; remediation evidence	S4	R3, R5	Market B pathway not confirmed (FU-05). A high-level regulatory overview was received (FU-06); its content was not supplied.
V4	Quality and safety	Complaints, incidents, recalls and CAPA; audit findings; definitions, period and comparator for any quality metric; independent verification	S3	R3	No follow-up evidence on quality records. Nothing is verified (FU-08).

ID	Area	Data required	Requested by	Supports	Follow-up status (Int-09)
V5	Technology and data	System and data-flow inventory; access-control design; incident and breach history; penetration-test findings; patching, backup and recovery tests; third-party dependencies	S5	R6	Platform collects device data per management (FU-02). Data rights unknown (FU-18). Integration decision open (FU-19).
V6	Financial	Reconciled historical financials; independent quality-of-earnings work; customer concentration; forecast; costed synergy register; sensitivity analysis; client investment thresholds	S6, S2	R3, R4	Summary financial information received (FU-06); not verified (FU-08). Thresholds not approved (FU-10).
V7	Operations and continuity	Capacity, workforce and supplier dependencies; delivery, stockout, downtime and backlog data; critical-operations map; continuity plan	S7	R7	No integration plan (FU-20). Stop authority not defined (FU-21). No follow-up evidence on capacity or suppliers.
V8	Customer and local view	Interviews with customers and local partners on why they choose the target and whether ownership change matters; independent quality reviewers; legal specialists	S8, S3, S4	R2, R5	Customer contact not permitted (FU-22). Reviewers can be engaged only once the data room opens (FU-23), and it is not yet open (FU-07).

7. Open questions for the client

The eight questions from version 1, with the status given by the client sponsor in the follow-up. Four new questions arise from the follow-up.

Question	Status after follow-up (Int-09)
Which target, business model, countries and products are in scope for this engagement?	Partly answered, as management's account (FU-01 to FU-04, FU-26). The Market B regulatory pathway is unconfirmed (FU-05).
What has management already provided, and what has been independently verified?	Answered: a presentation, summary financials and a high-level regulatory overview (FU-06). Nothing is verified (FU-08).
What are the client's investment thresholds, and who owns each decision gate?	Thresholds not approved (FU-10). Owners expected but not agreed (FU-11, FU-12).
Is partnership or organic entry still under consideration, and by what criteria will it be compared with acquisition?	Both remain open (FU-14). No criteria set (FU-15).
What does the client expect to do with the target's systems, data and any AI opportunity, and who owns those decisions?	AI is "an aspiration, not a plan" (FU-17). Data rights unknown (FU-18). Integrate-or-separate undecided (FU-19).
What integration approach is planned, and who has authority to stop a change that threatens safety or continuity?	No integration plan (FU-20). Authority to stop a change not defined (FU-21).
Which customers, partners and independent reviewers can we speak to, and when does confidentiality allow it?	Customer contact not permitted at this stage (FU-22). Reviewers only once the data room opens (FU-23).
When does the executive committee decide, and what evidence must be ready by then?	Planned for the end of next quarter, not fixed (FU-24). The sponsor wants unverified items flagged, not assumed (FU-25).

New questions arising from the follow-up (Int-09)

1. Who at the client owns the pause criteria that S1 describes, given that the expected owners named are the CMO, Regulatory Director and CFO (FU-11)?
2. Is the monitoring platform sold separately from the devices, and does it need separate approvals (FU-04, FU-05)?
3. When is the data room expected to open (FU-07), and will the customer contact restriction be lifted afterwards (FU-22)?
4. When will the board consider investment thresholds (FU-10)?

Appendix: Traceability to source statements

Quotes are verbatim from the transcripts. An ellipsis (…) marks a shortened quote. Classification follows the statement classification review. "Not in register" marks exact transcript quotes that were not given a register ID. Orange rows are follow-up statements from Interview 09, using the same IDs as Evidence Map v2. In those rows, the first column shows the insight, recommendation or validation action they support.

Insight	ID	Stakeholder	Exact quote	Classification / type
Insight 1: Thesis not yet testable				
1	ST-01b	S1	"we have not yet shown which of those advantages the target genuinely owns or whether we could achieve the same objective through a partnership."	2 Stakeholder-reported
1	ST-04	S1	"If the rationale depends on a market-entry advantage that is not exclusive"	5 Recommendation
1	Int-01	S1	"the target's reputation and capabilities do not transfer to our intended markets"	Not in register
1	ST-10	S2	"The team may assume that existing relationships automatically travel across borders or that our current sales force can cross-sell immediately."	4 Hypothesis
1	Int-02	S2	"That depends on the business model."	Not in register
1	Int-04	S4	"First, list the target's actual products and services and every country in which it operates or plans to enter."	Not in register
1	Int-06	S6	"That depends on the target."	Not in register
1	ST-38	S8	"If relationships depend on one founder or a few individuals, we need to know whether those people will remain and whether the relationships are institutional or personal."	4 Hypothesis
Insight 2: Verification and shared gates				
2	Int-01	S1	"We should show what we know, what management claims, and what remains untested."	Not in register
2	ST-08	S2	"rather than relying only on the target's pitch deck."	5 Recommendation
2	ST-11	S3	"Marketing material and testimonials alone do not establish clinical benefit."	3 Opinion
2	ST-14	S3	"how quality is measured, over what period, against which comparator, and who independently verified the data"	5 Recommendation
2	ST-15	S3	"Any unresolved material safety concern, repeated serious quality finding, unreliable clinical claims, or uncosted remediation plan should be escalated before commitment."	5 Recommendation
2	ST-17	S4	"We should reconcile management's answers with original records."	5 Recommendation
2	ST-20	S4	"An unclear licence or registration status, material undisclosed regulator correspondence, serious unresolved quality findings, …"	5 Recommendation
2	ST-23	S5	"A policy document alone does not prove controls work."	3 Opinion
2	ST-28	S6	"Reconcile reported revenue to contracts, invoices, cash collections and underlying activity."	5 Recommendation
2	ST-31	S6	"If critical assumptions cannot be validated, the recommendation may need to be conditional or the decision paused."	5 Recommendation
2	ST-41	S8	"which assumptions are supported by customer evidence rather than management optimism."	5 Recommendation
Insight 3: Pathway, not assumptions				
3	ST-02	S1	"A broad statement that healthcare demand is growing is not enough to justify this target or its valuation."	3 Opinion
3	ST-07	S2	"Market growth does not automatically become revenue for one company."	3 Opinion
3	ST-16	S4	"We must not assume one country's approval works everywhere."	5 Recommendation
3	ST-19	S4	"The forecast should model the relevant pathway, not simply assume a launch date."	5 Recommendation

Insight	ID	Stakeholder	Exact quote	Classification / type
3	ST-24	S5	"Poor migration or interoperability can interrupt workflows, make records unavailable, break interfaces, or compromise data integrity."	3 Opinion
3	ST-32	S7	"A market forecast does not tell us whether the target can safely deliver the extra demand."	3 Opinion
3	ST-35	S7	"Changing suppliers, systems, processes or leadership too quickly can disrupt availability, care workflows, service levels or quality."	3 Opinion
3	ST-37	S8	"Do not equate a large healthcare market with an accessible market."	5 Recommendation
3	ST-39	S8	"Local registration or licensing steps, procurement cycles, reimbursement decisions where applicable, onboarding requirements, …"	3 Opinion
Technology lens (supports R6)				
R6	ST-21	S5	"We should identify which systems are essential to safe service and which are merely administrative."	5 Recommendation
R6	ST-22	S5	"What personal or health data is collected, why it is used, where it is stored, …"	5 Recommendation
R6	ST-25	S5	"Any AI opportunity should be treated as a hypothesis until data rights, workflow fit, safety, oversight and measurable benefits are established."	4 Hypothesis
R6	ST-26	S5	"Cyber remediation, licence and vendor costs, data migration, interoperability, …"	5 Recommendation
Follow-up interview (Int-09), client sponsor. Fictional practice transcript; IDs as in Evidence Map v2.				
1	FU-01	Client sponsor	"The target is a mid-sized medical technology company."	Management account, unverified
1, 3	FU-02	Client sponsor	"It makes two lines of connected medical devices and sells a cloud-based monitoring platform that collects data from them."	Management account, unverified
1	FU-03	Client sponsor	"That description comes from management's own presentation."	Stakeholder-reported status
1	FU-04	Client sponsor	"We have not yet seen product-level detail, and I cannot yet tell you whether the platform is sold separately from the devices."	Stakeholder-reported status
3	FU-05	Client sponsor	"Our regulatory team has not confirmed the pathway for Market B."	Stakeholder-reported status
2	FU-06	Client sponsor	"Management has given us a presentation, summary financial information and a high-level regulatory overview."	Stakeholder-reported status
2	FU-07	Client sponsor	"The data room has not been opened to us yet."	Stakeholder-reported status
2	FU-08	Client sponsor	"Nothing has been independently verified."	Stakeholder-reported status
2	FU-09	Client sponsor	"So everything we currently believe about the Target is management's account."	Stakeholder-reported status
2	FU-10	Client sponsor	"The board has not approved investment thresholds."	Stakeholder-reported status
2	FU-11	Client sponsor	"I would expect the Chief Medical Officer and the Regulatory Director to be able to escalate a safety or compliance concern, and the CFO to own the financial gate."	Stakeholder expectation (hypothesis)
2	FU-12	Client sponsor	"But that is my expectation. It has not been written down or agreed."	Stakeholder-reported status
2	FU-13	Client sponsor	"That has not been decided."	Stakeholder-reported status (whether CMO or Regulatory escalation would stop the process)
1	FU-14	Client sponsor	"Both are still open in principle."	Stakeholder-reported status
1, 3	FU-15	Client sponsor	"We have not set criteria for comparing the three routes."	Stakeholder-reported status
3	FU-16	Client sponsor	"At the moment the preference for acquisition rests on a belief that it is faster, and nobody has put a timeline against each option."	Stakeholder-reported belief and status

Insight	ID	Stakeholder	Exact quote	Classification / type
R6	FU-17	Client sponsor	"That is an aspiration, not a plan."	Stakeholder-reported status (AI or analytics use of platform data)
R6	FU-18	Client sponsor	"We do not know what rights the Target has over that data, where it is stored, or whether it crosses borders."	Stakeholder-reported status
3	FU-19	Client sponsor	"We have not decided whether to integrate the Target's platform into our systems or keep it separate."	Stakeholder-reported status
3	FU-20	Client sponsor	"There is no integration plan."	Stakeholder-reported status
3	FU-21	Client sponsor	"Authority to stop a change is not defined."	Stakeholder-reported status
1	FU-22	Client sponsor	"Contact with the Target's customers is not permitted at this stage."	Stakeholder-reported status
V8	FU-23	Client sponsor	"Independent reviewers, such as quality and legal specialists, can be engaged through advisers, but only once the data room opens."	Stakeholder-reported status
3	FU-24	Client sponsor	"The decision is currently planned for the end of next quarter, although the date is not fixed."	Stakeholder-reported plan
2	FU-25	Client sponsor	"If we cannot verify something by then, I would rather the committee see it flagged than assumed."	Stakeholder preference (opinion)
1	FU-26	Client sponsor	"It currently operates in one market, which I will call Market A. The market we are considering entering is Market B."	Management account, unverified